

Documentation v1.0 | July 2026

Complete guide for setting up, using, and managing the church attendance tracking system

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1 System Overview

The JILGM-STBC Attendance System is a Progressive Web App (PWA) that enables fast, digital attendance tracking for Sunday services. It runs on any phone or computer with a browser.

How It Works (End-to-End)

Printed QR Poster → Member Scans & Registers → Personal QR Emailed → Usher Scans on Sunday → Report Auto-Generated

System Components

COMPONENT	PURPOSE	WHERE
Attendance App (PWA)	Check-in interface used by ushers	GitHub Pages (online)
Google Form	Member registration form	Google Forms
Google Sheets	Database (members, attendance, reports)	Church Google account
Google Apps Script	Backend automation (QR emails, sync API)	Church Google account



Zero cost. All components use free Google services and free GitHub hosting. No subscriptions or servers needed.

2 Initial Setup (One-Time)

This setup only needs to be done once. After this, the system runs automatically.

A. Install the App on Usher Phones

1 Open the app URL in Chrome

Open Chrome on your phone and navigate to the app URL provided by the admin.

2 Install as app

Tap the three-dot menu (top right) and select "Install app" or "Add to Home Screen." The app will appear on your home screen with the JILGM logo.

3 Configure the sync URL

Open the app, go to Settings tab, paste the Google Apps Script URL in the "Script URL" field, and tap "Test Connection." You should see "Connected."

4 Sync members

Tap "Sync Now" to pull all registered members from the database. You should see "Synced! X members loaded."



The Script URL only needs to be entered once per device. It is saved locally and persists across app restarts.

B. Print the Registration QR Code

1 Generate QR image

Open this URL in a browser to get the QR code image of your registration form. Save the image.

2 Print on poster/tarpaulin

Print the QR code large enough to scan from a distance. Place it at the church entrance, lobby, or registration area.

3 Add instructions

Below the QR, add text like: "Scan this QR code to register. You will receive your personal attendance QR via email."

3 Member Registration Flow

Members register themselves by scanning the printed QR poster. No usher action required.

What Members Do

1 Scan the QR poster

Using their phone camera or any QR scanner app.

2 Fill out the Google Form

Name, email, phone, birthday, outreach location, ministry, gender, civil status, etc.

3 Submit

The system automatically registers them and assigns a unique Member ID (e.g., MEM-001).

4 Receive personal QR via email

Within seconds, the member receives an email with their personal QR code image. This is what they show to ushers on Sunday.

What Happens Behind the Scenes

ACTION	AUTOMATED BY
Form response saved to Members sheet	Google Apps Script (onFormSubmit trigger)
Unique Member ID generated (MEM-XXX)	Google Apps Script

QR code image generated	QR Code API
QR saved to Google Drive	Google Apps Script
Email sent with QR attachment	Google Apps Script (GmailApp)
Member appears on usher app (within 60s)	Auto-sync

 **Email required.** Members must provide a valid email address to receive their QR code. If they don't have email, an usher can manually add them via the app and show them their QR from the Member Detail screen.

4 Check-In Modes

The app offers 4 ways to check in members. Use whichever is fastest for your situation.

Mode 1: QR Scan

The primary check-in method. Members show their personal QR code (from email or saved screenshot), and the usher scans it with the app.

FEATURE	DETAIL
Camera	Front and back camera supported (tap "Flip Camera" to switch)
Speed	Scans in under 1 second
Feedback	Green overlay with "Welcome, [Name]!" + audio beep
Duplicates	If already checked in, shows warning "already checked in"
Unknown QR	If QR doesn't match any member, shows "Member not found"

Mode 2: Quick Tap

A visual grid of all member avatars. Tap once to check in.

FEATURE	DETAIL
Display	Circular avatars with initials (or photo if uploaded)
Visual cues	Green ring = already checked in. Orange "N" badge = new/returning member.
Filters	Filter by ministry. Toggle "All" vs "Not Here" (show only unchecked).

Best for	Small-to-medium congregations where ushers know members by face
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Mode 3: Search

Type a member's name to find and check them in.

FEATURE	DETAIL
Search	Live search as you type (shows first 10 matches)
Already here	Shows "Already here" label next to checked-in members
Best for	When member forgot their QR and you need to find them by name

Mode 4: Visitor (Walk-in)

For first-time guests who haven't registered yet.

FEATURE	DETAIL
Access	Tap "New Visitor" card in Search mode
Fields	Name (required), Phone (optional), Notes (optional)
Result	Visitor is added as a member AND checked in simultaneously
Follow-up	They can complete full registration via the form later



Recommendation: Use QR Scan as primary mode for speed. Use Quick Tap for members who forgot their QR. Use Search as a fallback. Use Visitor for walk-ins.

5 Member Management

The Members tab provides full access to view, add, edit, and manage all members.

Member List

The list shows all members with their avatar, name, outreach, ministry, and status badge.

Filters Available

FILTER	OPTIONS
Status	All / Active / Inactive
Ministry	Any ministry from the configured list
Outreach	Sto. Tomas / Tanauan / Naujan / Socorro
Search	Live name search

Adding a Member Manually

Tap the + button (FAB) on the Members tab. Fill in the form fields:

FIELD	REQUIRED	NOTES
Full Name	Yes	
Outreach	No	Defaults to Sto. Tomas
Email	No	Needed for QR email
Phone	No	

Birthday	No	Used for age group calculation
Gender	No	Used for Mothers/Fathers grouping
Civil Status	No	Single/Married/Widow/Separated
Has Children	No	Affects age group (Mothers/Fathers vs YPro)
Ministry	No	Select from configured list
Membership Status	No	First Time Guest / Regular / Returning
D-Group Leader	No	
Emergency Contact	No	Name + phone number
Classes Attended	No	Checkboxes: 101, 102, 201, 301, 401, SOP 1, SOP 2, SOW, PCS

Member Detail Panel

Tap any member in the list to open their full profile. Shows:

- Avatar (photo or colored initials)
- Contact info (phone, address, email)
- Birthday and computed age
- Age group classification
- Last 10 Sundays attendance trail (green dots = present, gray = absent)
- Personal QR code display
- Action buttons: Edit, Show QR, Resend QR, Delete

Membership Status Pipeline

FIRST TIME GUEST → RETURNING GUEST → REGULAR ATTENDEE

Transitions are automatic: after 4 check-ins, a member graduates to Regular Attendee. If a Regular becomes inactive and returns, they become Returning Guest until they attend 4 more times.

6 Reports

The Reports tab shows today's attendance statistics and enables report generation.

Dashboard Stats

CARD	SHOWS
Checked In Today	Number of members checked in for today's service
Total Active Members	All members with "Active" status
Children Today	Manually entered children count
Visitors This Month	Members registered in the current calendar month
Weekly Average	Average attendance over the last 8 Sundays

Weekly Bar Chart

Visual chart showing attendance for the last 8 Sundays. Animated bars with count labels.

Ministry Breakdown

Shows present/total for each ministry with progress bars. Sorted by total members. Includes "(unassigned)" for members without a ministry.

Follow-Up List

Automatically identifies active members absent for 3 or more consecutive Sundays. These members may need follow-up.

Generate & Send Report

Tap "Generate Report" to create a formatted breakdown:

CATEGORY	LOGIC
Youth	Age 13-17 (Sto. Tomas only)
YPro	Age 18+ AND single AND no children (Sto. Tomas only)
Mothers	Female AND (married/widow/separated OR has children) (Sto. Tomas only)
Fathers	Male AND (married/widow/separated OR has children) (Sto. Tomas only)
Children	Manually entered count
Outreach groups	Separate count per location (Tanauan, Naujan, Socorro)
New	First Time Guests from Sto. Tomas only
Grand Total	Adults + Children + Outreach totals

Tap "Send Now" to email the report to the configured Report Email address. The report is also logged in the Google Sheet "Reports" tab.

7 Settings & Configuration

Connection

FIELD	PURPOSE
Script URL	The Google Apps Script Web App URL. Required for sync to work. Locked after saving (tap "Edit URL" to change).
Test Connection	Pings the backend. Shows "Connected" or "Failed."

Report Settings

FIELD	PURPOSE
Report Email	Email address where reports are sent
Default Outreach Location	Pre-fills the outreach field in reports (default: "STB")

Sync

FIELD	PURPOSE
Last Synced	Shows when the last successful sync occurred
Pending Changes	Number of offline check-ins waiting to be uploaded
Sync Now	Manually triggers push (upload pending) + pull (download members)

Data Management

ACTION	WHAT IT DOES
Import CSV	Bulk-import members from a CSV file
Export CSV	Download all members as a CSV file
Load Demo Data	Loads 20 sample members + 8 weeks of fake attendance (for testing only)

Ministry Management

View, add, or remove ministries from the configured list. Changes apply to all dropdowns (filters, member form, Quick Tap filter).

Default Ministries

Abraham, Admin, Children, Dance, Engineering, Evangelism, Finance, Kitchen, Media Arts, Prayer, Social Concern, Well Watered Women (W3), Worship, Young Professional, Youth

8 Outreach Tracking

The system supports tracking members from multiple outreach locations with different attendance rules.

Supported Locations

LOCATION	SERVICE SCHEDULE	INACTIVITY RULE
Sto. Tomas (Main)	Every Sunday	Inactive after 8 consecutive Sundays absent
Tanauan	1st Sunday of month	Inactive after 8 consecutive 1st Sundays absent (~8 months)
Naujan	Varies	No auto-inactive (grace for remote area)
Socorro	Varies	No auto-inactive (grace for remote area)

How Outreach Affects Reports

- **Sto. Tomas members** are counted in the age bracket breakdown (Youth, YPro, Mothers, Fathers)
- **Other outreach members** (Tanauan, Naujan, Socorro) appear as separate line items in the report, NOT counted in age brackets
- **"New" count** only includes First Time Guests from Sto. Tomas. First-timers from other outreaches show under their outreach line.

9 Sync & Offline Usage

Auto-Sync (Background)

Every 60 seconds, the app silently:

- Pushes any pending offline check-ins to Google Sheets
- Pulls today's attendance (from other usher devices)
- Pulls new members (registered via form)

No toast or popup appears. This is completely silent.

Manual Sync

Tap "Sync Now" in Settings to force an immediate sync. Shows a toast with results.

Offline Mode

If internet is unavailable (e.g., poor signal at church):

- All check-in modes still work normally
- Check-ins are saved locally in IndexedDB
- A "Pending Changes" counter shows how many are queued
- When internet returns, auto-sync uploads everything



Multi-device: Multiple ushers can check in simultaneously on different phones. All data merges correctly via the backend. No conflicts or duplicates.

PWA Installation

Once installed as a PWA ("Add to Home Screen"), the app:

- Opens fullscreen (no browser bar)
- Has its own home screen icon with JILGM logo
- Works offline (cached by service worker)
- Appears in app switcher like a native app

10 Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
"No sync URL configured"	Go to Settings, paste the Script URL, and tap Save.
Sync shows 0 members	The Script URL may be outdated. Ask admin to check if the Web App was redeployed as a new version.
Camera not working (QR Scan)	The app needs HTTPS to access the camera. Make sure you're using the online URL (not a local file). Also check browser camera permissions.
Member not found on scan	The member may not be synced yet. Tap Sync Now, then try again. Or use Quick Tap / Search mode.
App opens in browser (not standalone)	Uninstall the shortcut, revisit the URL, and re-install. May need to open twice for the service worker to activate.
Toast notification sticks on screen	Pull down to refresh the page. This is a rare caching issue that resolves after the next app update.
Report email not received	Check the Report Email field in Settings. Also check spam folder. Ensure the Script URL is connected.
Member registered but not appearing	Wait 60 seconds for auto-sync, or tap Sync Now manually.
QR email not received by member	Check if the email field was filled correctly in the form. Open the member's detail in the app and tap "Resend QR."
Internet lost during service	No problem. Continue checking in normally. All data is saved locally and syncs when internet returns.

 **If all else fails:** Clear the app's site data in Chrome settings, reopen the URL, re-enter the Script URL, and Sync Now. This resets the local cache while preserving all server-side data.

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Prepared by Media Arts Ministry